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Trump Makes It Very Clear They’re Going To Turn TikTok Into A Right Wing Propaganda Machine



from the *everything-is-propaganda-now* dept

Tue, Sep 30th 2025 05:22am - **Karl Bode**

After years of hyperventilation about TikTok’s impact on privacy, propaganda, and national security, TikTok is likely being sold to a bunch of Trump’s billionaire technofascist buddies who don’t believe in privacy and **want to use TikTok to spread right wing propaganda**. Bang up job all around, especially to all the befuddled Democrats **whose hysteria about the app helped Trump seal the deal**.

Deals

TikTok’s new owners will include Rupert Murdoch (responsible for creating Fox News, the most effective mass media right wing propaganda platform **ever**) and Trump bestie Larry Ellison, who is in the process of turning CBS News **into basically the same thing via his nepo baby son and Bari Weiss**.

Normally you’d want to be a little subtle about the plan to turn TikTok into a pro-Trump and pro-Netanyahu propaganda machine to avoid scaring off customers, but that’s not Trump’s style. So last week **he basically just blurted out the whole plan**, then insisted he was just “joking”:

“Trump signed an **executive order** to “save” TikTok, while supposedly **joking** that he’d like to censor influencers by tweaking the algorithm so that content is “100 percent MAGA.”

“Everyone is going to be treated fairly,” the president added—seemingly covering his tracks as critics warn that TikTok under US ownership could soon carry a right-wing bias, **perhaps** going the way of Twitter after Elon Musk took over and rebranded it as X.”

Yes, “perhaps.”

From Twitter and the **Washington Post** to **CBS News**, the right wing billionaire tendency to buy up major media properties and convert them into right wing propaganda and bullshit machines has not been subtle. Yet, as the **framing of this Ars piece makes clear**, the press still seems somewhat confused as to whether TikTok will be any sort of reliable source of information (spoiler: it won’t) under far right wing billionaire ownership.

TikTok under Bytedance ownership certainly raised privacy, propaganda, and national security concerns. But under Bytedance the platform at least **tried** to behave so it could continue operating in the U.S. With Trump **having dismantled all our privacy, NatSec, and fraud regulators**, the new U.S. ownership of TikTok will see *arguably fewer regulatory constraints on their worst impulses than ever*.

Murdoch clearly wants a modern media extension of his existing Fox News empire given his core audience is dying off. Ellison, a staunch supporter of Netanyahu and *his industrialized mass murder of children*, clearly wants to leverage TikTok as a new media extension for **whatever fresh hell he and Bari Weiss are building over at CBS**. I’d expect ample authoritarian apologia.

To be clear the deal hasn’t been fully finalized yet. It’s still not clear if the deal will meet the legal requirements of the Protecting Americans from Foreign Adversary Controlled Applications Act, especially given there seems to be **some ongoing debate over who’ll exactly own the underlying algorithm**. There will likely be some opportunities for activists and lawyers to throw sand in the gears.

But make no mistake: if this deal goes through TikTok will **absolutely** be headed the way of Twitter under Elon Musk. They’ll likely try to leave things much the same for a 6-12 months to pretend that’s not going to be the case, but I suspect that, ultimately, its use for right wing propaganda will be obvious.

Creating an internet full of wall-to-wall racist and corporatist right wing agitprop was always the end game of MAGA’s bogus “Conservative censorship” and “we support antitrust reform now” claims, it was never remotely subtle, and **you can’t say you weren’t warned, repeatedly**.

You’d like to think that the conversion of TikTok into a far right wing safe space will cause a mass exodus of ethical people off of the platform, but as we’ve seen with Twitter (especially when it comes to journalists’ continued use of a website owned by an overt white supremacist) that’s clearly not really something you can truly rely on.

You’d also like to think that the hijacking of TikTok will create the opportunity for innovators to create a better, more ethical short-form video platform *not owned by assholes actively cheering on the destruction of foundational democracy*. Here too, time will tell.

Their goal is obvious but as some are quick to point out: **their success is far from guaranteed**. Remember what happened with Rupert Murdoch and MySpace? AT&T’s attempted domination of video? These sorts of domination plays, especially in mass modern media, never quite go the way rich brunchlords planned, and it’s not like Oracle executives have any sort of serious experience with consumer-facing product success, much less any understanding of modern media.

That said, you’d need to define “success.” The billionaire right wing architects of this new modern era right wing propaganda bullhorn (that may soon be comprised of Fox, CNN, Sinclair, TikTok, Twitter, and countless other media properties) have no limit of money to burn on profit-losing propaganda ventures in a country that just took a hatchet to any remaining financial or consumer protection regulators.

They may never have the competency to actually execute, but given the already extremely shaky status of journalism, the media, and informed consensus, I think emphatic alarmism remains the right response to the grand, unsubtle mass media plans of our shittiest billionaires.

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Anonymous Coward September 30, 2025 at 6:56 am

“Everyone is going to be treated fairly”

Sorry Donald, but “fair” doesn’t even exist in your 500-word vocabulary. I don’t even know when you could have heard this word.
So just use “stupidly”, as usual.

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Ninja (profile) September 30, 2025 at 7:11 am

INSIDER

It's a pattern. The fascists are controlling everything via financial prowess. Musk bought Twitter to bend it to his will. EA and e-sports in general are being bent to bloody regimes, in line with the ideology Musk, Trump follow.

Billionaires, super rich are a cancer that will destroy everything. World War II was just a battle. The war is still raging.

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Anonymous Coward September 30, 2025 at 7:26 am

Re:

Billionaires are becoming the new James Nolan Masons and Bradley Cadenheads.

I wonder which billionaire will become the new Osama bin Laden.

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Stephen T. Stone (profile) September 30, 2025 at 9:55 am

Re: Re:

I'd put my money on Elon Musk.

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David September 30, 2025 at 7:12 am

Political culture decline

Trump has become too senile to figure out plausible deniability any more.

Once he is gone, how are politicians supposed to regain their respect for voters after the ample demonstration of what mouldy-shit-for-brains is permitted to insult their intelligence with, without repercussions?

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completely blown out of proportion by people willfully misreading/misunderstanding how moderation works.

John Roddy: I recently saw someone provide some pretty reasonable sounding feedback. And then added on "oh and stop banning Palestinians"

So yeah, big time perception issues. Which is easily the hardest part of moderation at scale to address.

> Bluesky doesn't have balloons for birthdays, so I gotta settle for the Twitter ones.

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Diogenes (profile) September 30, 2025 at 8:09 am

maga dont work on tiktok

I dont think the kind of people that do tiktok are going to stick around for forced maga.

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💡 😏 “ ” 🚩

[2]



Ebenezer Scrooge September 30, 2025 at 9:19 am

Re:

I think you are correct. Tiktok is for young 'uns. Young 'uns don't like old people's media. It will go the way of Facebook, even if goes the toxic masculinity route. At best, it will steal some of Twitter's business. Worse yet for Tiktok, because Facebook actually appeals to the olds, and Tiktok doesn't.

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Anonymous Coward September 30, 2025 at 8:15 am

In case anybody's considering a parody site: the domain **shitshok.com** is still unclaimed.

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MrWilson (profile) September 30, 2025 at 10:00 am

Re:

Feel free to offer practical, effective solutions. Also, why aren't you doing anything except telling others to do something?

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[3]



MrWilson (profile) September 30, 2025 at 10:02 am

Re: Re:

Ignore this. Page reloaded on the wrong comment. How do you get a too many requests error the first you visit the page?

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Epic September 30, 2025 at 9:09 am

Doesn't seem like anyone's gonna do anything?

What are you going to do about it write another strongly worded article?? Exactly, everyone is doing nothing... Just clapping around the trough for the next news cycle and outrage bait...DO SOMETHING!!! The world can't bail you out and won't... This is your mess clean it up!

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[2]



Stephen T. Stone (profile) September 30, 2025 at 9:58 am

Re:

What would you like us to do? Because it's not as if the average person can do anything about this. Hell, even a whole boycott/call-in/protest campaign won't really change the outcome of this situation. The only people with the power to stop the TikTok deal from happening sit in the halls of power in the U.S. and China; if they're not willing to stop it, it won't be stopped.

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MrWilson (profile)

September 30, 2025 at 10:01 am

Re:

Feel free to offer practical, effective solutions. Also, why aren't you doing anything except telling others to do something?

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Pixelation

September 30, 2025 at 9:21 am

"Everyone"

I don't think that word means what Trump thinks it means.

Like when he said about the tariffs, "All I know is this—we're going to become so rich." He also does not seem to know what the word "we" means.

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